

THE SCRAMBLE FOR METEORIC IRON

At least five nations established mining exclusion zones around their nether portals on Saturday after the rolling out of the new Heliodor plugin. Some nations that did so include the Empire of Pavia and Griffin, the Fempire Union, the Imperial Federation, Nara, and Yoahatl.

The nations that set up mining exclusion zones announced their decisions on their respective Discord servers, stating that those who are excluded aren't nation members or lack authorization to mine.

"The Fempire portal is now closed to anyone that is not a member of the Fempire Union or an authorized person by a member of the Central Committee," tb, the marshal of the Fempire Union, said on his nation's Discord server.

Some officials stated that people who break the new exclusion zone policies will be punished severely.

"We are still hashing that out," x1025, the Alcuahatl of Yoahatl, said of the specific punishment that violators of the Yoahatl exclusion zone would receive. "But it will be a harsh punishment."

Although the announcements did not give a reason for the new exclusion zones, officials interviewed by the Karydian Times said that the motivation came from the n

Cissonius (domiii. on Discord), the first Lord of the Pavia and Griffin admiralty; slothinasuit (destroh. on Discord), the head of defense of the Imperial Federation; and x1025 all said that their respective nations created their exclusion zones because of the new Heliodor plugin.

According to the CivMC wiki, the Heliodor plugin adds a new, rare resource called meteoric iron. As an ore, it can only be found and mined just under the surface and near nether portals.

"The Heliodor plugin adds a new branch to the tech tree through a high cost resource called meteoric iron," the wiki reads.

"This material is only found in small veins just underneath the surface, and only near portals."

slothinasuit said that the Imperial Federation's exclusion zone was specifically set up to guard the new meteoric iron veins near their nation's nether portal.

"This is because the meteoric ore veins only spawn near portals," slothinasuit said.

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Although x1025 said that he expects meteoric iron to be a useful resource, he and other officials said that their nations are still trying to determine how valuable the resource will be.

“Meteoric iron is expected to be useful, but how useful remains to be seen,” x1025 said. “We are yet to determine the value of them,” Cissonius said of meteoric iron.

Some officials expressed doubt over the extent to which meteoric iron will be a good resource addition to CivMC. Cissonius said that the resource may be “disastrous” if it falls into the wrong hands.

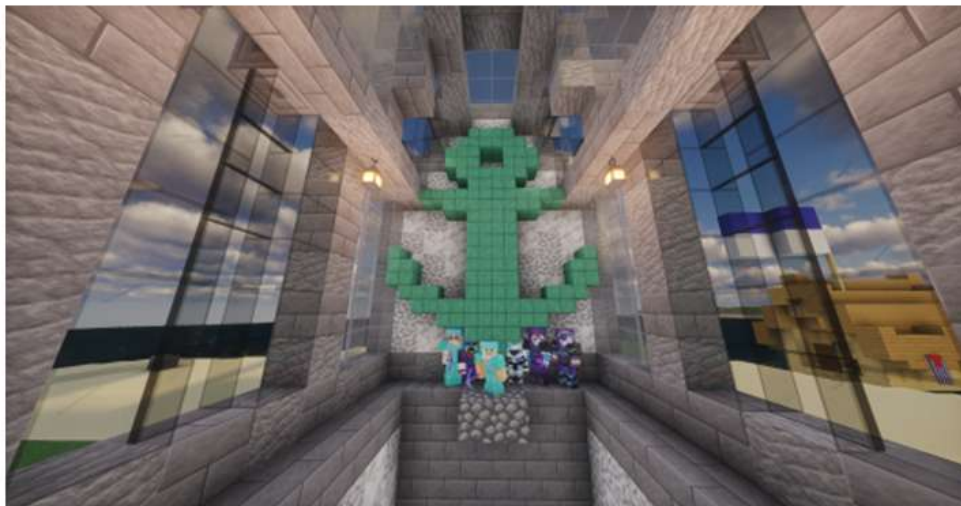
“We are dubious at best over the addition of the new ore in its current state,” Cissonius said. “This implementation as is spells disastrous consequences for many on the server if a raider group were to be geared with this item.”

x1025 said that the addition of meteoric iron may worsen wealth inequality between richer nations and poorer nations.

“I feel quite bad for the nations that will be left without access to this new resource,” x1025 said. “I fear this will only make the rich nations richer and the poor nations poorer (even though Yoahtl is a rich nation itself).”

The national announcements stated that further updates will come as the various governments make long-term plans for what to do in regard to the new plugin.

“Ultimately we look to return to normality soon,” Cissonius said.



Pictured above: the Lambat portal